Shared risk worksheet: a fictional worked example

Stochastic Parrots and Beyond · fictional example

> ! Fictional example
>
> The person, the project, the vendor, and the contract are invented for teaching. No real submission, person, or product is described.

A doctoral candidate in political science plans to use a hosted chatbot. The chatbot is licensed by the university. The candidate wants to translate and summarize 40 French policy documents for a literature review.

Field	Notes
Research use	Translate and summarize 40 public French policy documents for a literature review.
System or vendor	A hosted chatbot that the university licenses from “Vendor X”. Record the version and the date of use.
Evidence source	The vendor’s terms of use and the university’s license page. No published documentation of the training data.
Lifecycle stage	Deployment (use of a hosted service) and evaluation (checking the translations).
People affected	The candidate; the readers of the review; the authors of the documents, who can be misrepresented; data workers behind the model (unknown).
Risk or benefit	Benefit: a faster first reading. Risks: mistranslated legal terms, invented content in summaries, an unknown energy cost per request.
Severity and uncertainty	Medium severity for the conclusions of the review. High uncertainty about the training data and the error rate for legal French.
Existing mitigation	The license contract keeps uploads out of model training. Fictional contract term.
Possible alternative	Read the originals with a dictionary; test a smaller local translation model; ask a bilingual colleague to check a sample.
Disclosure requirement	State the tool, the version, the date, and the purpose in the methods section. Follow the AI policy of the target journal.
Institutional owner	The supervisor and the research data office.
Next action	Check five translated passages against the originals within two weeks, and record the error rate.

Decision in this example. The candidate uses the chatbot for a first reading only. All quotations and all arguments in the review come from the original documents. The methods section discloses the use.

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